

Northwind Analytics Compensation and Benefits Policy

Purpose and Scope

This document sets out how Northwind Analytics determines pay, reviews salaries and administers benefits. It covers all permanent employees and is reference COMP-2.4, effective 1 April 2025.

Compensation decisions are made by the line manager, moderated by a calibration panel and approved by the Head of People Operations. Individual salaries are confidential.

Salary Bands

Every role is mapped to one of seven levels, from L1 for entry level to L7 for principal and director roles. Each level has a band with a minimum, a midpoint and a maximum.

The midpoint of each band is set at the median of the market benchmark for the role and location, using survey data refreshed every twelve months.

An offer above the midpoint of a band requires approval from the Head of People Operations. An offer above the band maximum is not permitted; the role must be re-levelled instead.

Annual Review Cycle

The salary review cycle runs once per year. Proposals are submitted in February, calibrated in March, and any increase takes effect from 1 April.

Employees who joined after 1 October are not included in the following April cycle and are reviewed in the subsequent year.

Out-of-cycle increases are permitted only for a promotion, a role change, or a documented retention risk approved by a member of the executive team.

Promotion

Promotion requires demonstrated performance at the next level for at least two consecutive review periods, evidenced in a written promotion case.

Promotion cases are reviewed twice a year, in March and in September. A promotion carries a minimum salary increase of 8 percent, subject to the band maximum.

Variable Pay

All employees participate in a company bonus scheme with a target of 10 percent of base salary. The scheme pays between 0 and 150 percent of target depending on company performance against the annual operating plan.

The sales team participates in a commission plan instead of the company bonus scheme. Commission is paid monthly and is subject to a clawback if a customer cancels within 90 days of contract signature.

Bonus is paid in March for the preceding calendar year. Employees must be employed and not under notice on the payment date to receive a bonus.

Pension and Insurance

The company contributes 6 percent of base salary to a pension scheme and matches employee contributions up to a further 3 percent.

Life insurance is provided at four times base salary. Income protection pays 60 percent of base salary after a 13-week deferral period.

Private medical cover is available to all employees after three months of service and may be extended to a partner and dependent children at the employee's cost.

Referral and Recognition

A successful employee referral pays 2000 euro for engineering roles and 1200 euro for all other roles. The bonus is paid after the referred employee completes three months of service.

Spot recognition awards of up to 500 euro may be granted by any director without further approval.